UNIT 4 SPIRITUAL DEVELOPMENT

Structure

4.1 Introduction

4.2 Objectives

4.3 Meaning of Spiritual Development

4.3.1 Spirituality

4.4 Religion and Spiritual Development

4.4.1 What is Religion?

4.4.2 Happiness and Spiritual Development

4.5 Science and Spiritual Development

4.6 Indian Approach towards Spiritual Development

4.6.1 Indian Thought of Self-Knowledge

4.6.2 Human needs & Self-fulfillment

4.7 Yoga and Religion

4.7.1 Concept of yoga

4.7.2 Benefits of Yoga

4.8 Meditation

4.8.1 Features of Meditation

4.9 Spiritual Integration

4.10 Let Us Sum Up

4.11 Answers to Check Your Progress

4.12 References

4.1 INTRODUCTION

In the process of self-development, you have so far studied physical, emotional social and intellectual aspects. Man is a combination of body, mind and spirit - the conscious part of a person. Proper union amongst the three promotes a well-balanced personality. Such a person enjoys peace in 'personal', 'social' and or "environmental" inter-relationships. Every individual should be clear about one's vision and mission in life. Vision concerns one's personality and ambition in life. Mission relates to one's purpose in life. It concerns our surroundings: both living and non-living. Mission rises in quality, according to the level of one's consciousness; a spiritually developed person rises above petty conflicts in life and sees beyond selfish interests. For such a person the entire world is one family and he believes in the oneness and inter-dependence of all forms of matter and energy.

4.2 OBJECTIVES

After you read this unit you will come to know about:

- the meaning of spiritual development;
- the relationship between religion and science with spirituality;
- the of Indian approach to the development of spirituality;
- the importance of yoga and meditation towards spiritual development

4.3 MEANING OF SPIRITUAL DEVELOPMENT

Spiritual Development or knowledge of the Self means to experience original divinity in the human beings. As the visible parts of trees are supported by invisible roots, similarly human body's visible beautiful organs, sweet voice and movements are supported by an invisible energy that keeps it functioning and alive. The roots of human life lie in this subtle energy. This invisible life-energy is known as the Spirit or Soul. This living, non-physical entity holds our desires, emotions, thoughts and personality.

Spiritual development embraces everything with the sense of oneness. It soars above personal self-gain. With spiritual development one becomes concerned about the well-being of others and such a shift in attitude is termed as Transformation. By transformation, monotony changes into celebration and anger takes the form of inspiration. This caring and sharing attitude is called knowledge of the self which flushes out anger, hatred and jealousy.

Spiritual growth isn't so much about changing our world or our lives, but about changing ourselves and how we perceive the world. It is like waking up and seeing the world through a new pair of glasses. Our connections with others change. A holistic approach to our life and our overall health comes into being, and a balanced lifestyle becomes the goal. For example, we start eating better, quit smoking and start exercising, and so on. In addition to these, spiritual growth is also characterized by a growing connection with a higher power, which some might experience through prayer and meditation.

4.3.1 Spirituality

Spirituality is that which relates to or affects the human spirit or soul as opposed to material or physical things. Spirituality touches that part of oneself that is not dependant on material things or physical comforts. What is most obvious in the meaning of "spirituality" is that it comes from its root word, 'Spirit'. Spirit refers to those that cannot be directly perceived by our senses but which can be deduced or inferred by our observations like love, justice, peace, etc. spiritual development occurs when consciousness transcends the boundaries of body, language, reason, and culture. It is the movement from simple, dependent spiritual thought and behavior; toward subtle, contemplative, and transcendent understanding of both inner and outer life experiences. Spiritual development is a process of transcendence that could be seen as a continuing spiral of increasingly broad understanding and experience of oneself and the universe.

Essential Keys to Spiritual Development are the following:

1. Control of thoughts
2. Control of our actions
3. Equanimity
4. Understand every being
5. Complete openness
6. Inner harmony

4.4 RELIGION AND SPIRITUAL DEVELOPMENT

What is the difference between spirituality and religion? Religion refers to an institutionalized and codified set of beliefs and practices that is a cultural expression of a higher power. With that definition, reading and memorizing Scriptures, doing daily prayers and rituals, would be considered being religious. What is spirituality? It refers to a personal belief in and experience of a supreme being, or an ultimate human condition, a sense of connection and a sense of inner wholeness within or outside formal religious structures. Religion can be a way to express a person's spirituality. If someone's religion helps to enhance the experience of a supreme being for example, then religion can be just as important as a person's spirituality. In this sense a person can be both religious and spiritual. Judaism, Christianity and Islam, all preach helping and ministering to the poor and less fortunate.

Spiritual development gives substance or meaning to our religious life. Unless our religious life is accompanied by spiritual development, it merely remains a set of doctrines or practices. As members of society, we have a set of religious beliefs which define our religious identity and our religious life. If we are Christians we believe in God and in Jesus Christ. If we are Muslims we believe in Allah and if we are, Hindus we believe in Brahman and his diverse manifestations. But if we do not grow in our spiritual life we take these beliefs and practices for granted. We believe in them and do things as told to us by our religion because we think that those are expected of us. As we don't learn to internalize practices they do not really influence our lives.

The second relevance of spiritual development to our religious life is that it is the bond which unites all the religious groups in the world. There are around 20 major religions in the world. In the course of history up to the present time, these religious groups have disagreed with one another, sometimes violently. Wars have been fought in the name of religion and countless lives have been sacrificed. If we grow in our spiritual life, we realize that all of us are deeply united in spirit, no matter what our religion is, because it is the same Spirit who gives life to us and guides us to have religious peace and harmony.

4.4.1 What is Religion?

The word 'Religion' is derived from the Latin word '*religare*' where 're' means back, and '*ligare*' means to bind. So religion binds one to the origin. Religion is an organized belief, it is also known as 'Faith'. The Major religions of the World are: Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism & Sikhism (of Indian Origin), Judaism,

Christianity, Islam, Zoroastrianism& Baha'is (of S.W. Asian Origin), Taoism and Confucianism (from China), and Shintoism from Japan. The major religions in context of India may be elaborated:

- **Hinduism:** There is no unique philosophy that forms the basis of the faith of the majority of India's population. Hinduism is perhaps the only religious tradition that is so diversified in its theoretical premises and practical expressions as to be called a "museum of religions". The *Rig Veda, Upanishads* and the *Bhagwad Gita* can all be described as the sacred text of the Hindus. Unlike most other religions, Hinduism does not advocate the worship of one particular deity. At one end of the scale, it is an exploration of the 'Ultimate Reality'; at the other end there are cults that worship spirits, trees and animals. There are festivals and ceremonies associated not only with gods and goddesses but also with the sun, moon, planets, rivers, oceans, trees and animals. Some of the popular Hindu festivals are Deepawali, Holi, Dussehra, Ganesh Chaturthi, Pongal, Janamasthmi and Shiva Ratri. These innumerable festive occasions lend Hinduism its amazing popular appeal and make the Indian tradition rich and colorful.

- **Sikhism:** The Sikh religion founded by Guru Nanak, emerged in the 16th century, The Gurus who followed Nanak contributed to the consolidation and spread of Sikhism. The teachings of Guru Nanak were incorporated in the '*Guru Granth Sahib*', the Holy Book of the Sikhs. Sikhism propounds monotheism, i.e. worship of one God. It also opposes the caste system and believes that all men are equal. Today, many Sikh practices are common to Hindus. Though the Sikhs constitute less than 2 percent of the Indian population, they have become a distinct element in the configuration of the Indian religious tradition and the Indian society.

- **Buddhism:** Buddhism originated as an offshoot of Hinduism in India, but eventually it became popular all over Asia. The personality and teachings of Gautam Buddha, the founder of this faith, have illumined the lives of millions of people in Japan, China and Southeast Asia. There are strong lines'of similarity between Buddhism and the basic teachings of Hinduism. Buddhism rests upon four Noble Truths; (i) suffering is universal, (ii) it is caused by desire and yearning (iii) suffering can be prevented and overcome and (iv) eradication of desires can lead to removal of suffering. To prevent suffering one has to conquer craving and desire and this conquest leads to the attainment of *nirvana* or complete enlightenment.

- **Islam:** Unlike Buddhism, Jainism and Sikhism which emerged as offshoots of Hinduism, the concept, customs and religious practices of Islam were unique to this faith which professed universal brotherhood and submission to Allah-the God Almighty. The Muslim invaders in the 12th century and the Mughal rulers in the 16th and 17th centuries helped in the spread of Islam in India. In its first phase, Islam was aggressive. But the mystics of Islam, or the Sufi saints, helped in spreading the message of peace and universal love. The spirit of brotherhood propounded by Sufi saints and preachers like Kabir and Nanak helped in loosening the rigidity of the caste system. The interaction of the two faiths led to a synthesis of Hindu and Islamic elements in almost every sphere of life and culture. After an initial period of conflict and confrontation, today the two religions have accommodated and enriched each other.

- **Christianity:** By tradition, Christianity is said to have arrived in India with Saint Thomas, one of the apostles of Jesus Christ, who spent some years in South India and possibly died there. However, others believe that the first missionary to arrive in the country was Saint Bartholomew. Historically, Christian missionary activity started with the advent of Saint Francis Xavier in 1544. Throughout the 18th and 19th centuries Catholic as well as Protestant missionaries preached Christian doctrines in India and also made important contributions to social improvement and education in India. Much of the modern influences in the Indian society can be attributed to the role of Christianity in India. Christian missionaries helped in setting up schools and colleges all over India and also spread the message of faith and goodwill in the country. Christianity and its teachings influenced a number of intellectuals and thinkers in India, including Mahatma Gandhi. Today, the Christians in India number about 30 million and consist of people from every denomination of Christianity.

4.4.2 Happiness and Spiritual Development

Happiness is a complex feeling which can't be defined in just few lines. Every person has different description of happiness and thus, it can't be generalized. Different people have different perspective and thus different meanings of happiness. For instance, for a poverty stricken labour, getting two meals a day is a happy moment, while for an industrialist, a profit of millions is a reason to be happy. A small child is happy getting a Cadbury chocolate while an adult gets happy getting a good job. Thus, happiness is a feeling which varies from person to person. Therefore happiness is an ultimate feeling of self-contentment which depends on an individual's nature and attitude towards life. The link between spirituality and happiness is pretty well-established. More spirituality brings more happiness. Children who feel that their lives have meaning and values and who develop deep, quality relationships-both measures of spirituality, - are happier than the children greed in life Lack of spiritual beliefs can often make you feel like your life is empty and meaningless, while a strong spiritual foundation can help you see that there is a deeper part of you. You might call this your soul, spirit, essence or divinity, but the name doesn't matter as much as the realization that this part of you is timeless, infinite and wise – which helps you feel like "more" than you would as a limited physical person.

Thus happiness or peace is the art of enjoying life situations. It depends not on circumstances but on attitude and our approach to life. It is cultivated in three ways:-

- by learning positive habits e.g. serving, loving and helping others
- by unlearning the negative ways of living e.g. selfishness and not caring for others
- by counting our opportunities and not difficulties

4.5 SCIENCE AND SPIRITUAL DEVELOPMENT

Science investigates to know the truth about the universe. It studies phenomena of the physical and natural world, establishing the 'cause and effect' relationship.

Scientific temper and modernization are not against spiritual development. Even western scientists are now working for a balance between science and technology and search of the self. Science discovers the outer self whereas spirituality discovers the inner self. Harmony between Science and Spirituality is the need of the hour. Spiritual truths have been revealed through Vedanta or the Upanishads. Vedanta declares that human individual is physically limited but spiritually unlimited. Science and spiritual development must go hand in hand. Einstein said, "Religion is blind without Science and Science is lame without religion" Swami Vivekananda said, "What we want is western Science coupled with Vedanta".

Science and Spirituality are heading towards co-existence. World Health Organization (W.H.O.) has revised the definition of health by adding a spiritual dimension to its concept. W.H.O. now recognizes 'Yoga' as a great healer of many ailments.

Check Your Progress 2

1. What is the relationship between Science and Spiritual development?

   .....

   .....

   .....

2. What is spirituality?

   .....

   .....

   .....

3. How is religion and spiritual development related?

   .....

   .....

   .....

4. Briefly state what is happiness?

   .....

   .....

   .....

4.6 INDIAN APPROACH TOWARDS SPIRITUAL DEVELOPMENT

Indian Philosophy is essentially spiritual. It is dressed up in myths, legends and stories to cater to the understanding of the common man. The founders of philosophy strive for a socio-spiritual reformation of the country. The ultimate truths are truths of the spirit and this very crux echoes the spirituality in Indian philosophy in a subtle way. Indian philosophy is embedded in the doctrines of Indian religion which includes the teachings of Buddha, the philosophies of Mahavira or the thoughts of Sankara. Belief in God is an inseparable part of Indian religion and indeed that of the Indian philosophy. The beauty of the Indian philosophy gains dimension as it colossally unifies the Metaphysical God with the Personal God who is the basis of all morality and ethics. The concept of ***Ishvara*** is the very core of Indian Philosophy. ***Ishvara*** in Sanskrit means, the Lord. In Indian

philosophy therefore Ishvara is considered as the ultimate Ruler, the supreme power and is indeed the preternatural being of the Cosmos. According to Indian philosophy, God is the creator, the preserver and the destroyer of the cosmos. Brahman is the symbol of divinity in Indian philosophy and therefore remains the symbol of the Divine essence of the cosmos. The reference of **Brahman** is also in the *MundakaUpanishad,* which is regarded **as** the basis of the Indian philosophy. The concept of spirituality in the form of God or Ishvara, as supreme power leading to eternal bliss is also imparted in the Bhagwad Gita.

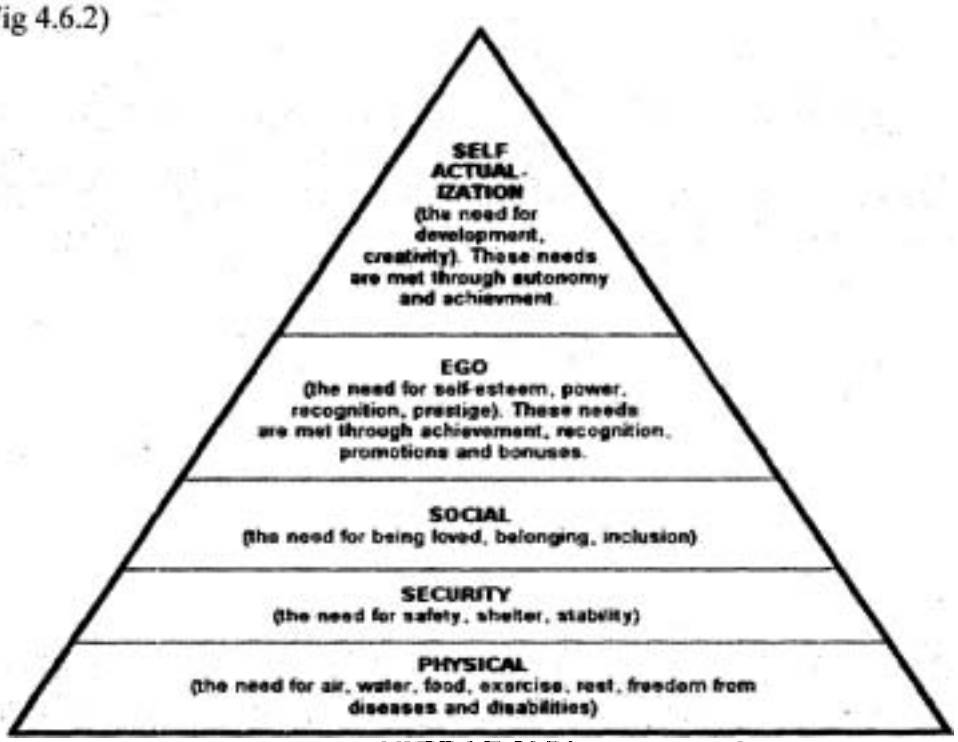
4.6.1 Indian Thought of Self-Knowledge

The crux of Indian thought is that we are not bodies (matter) but we are divine spirit (soul).

This **coordinal** realization is hammered again and **again** through the Vedas which speaks of the interdependence of **earth;** atmosphere and human life. The *Bhagwad* Gita teaches that the everlasting soul does not die, only the body made from the **matter** perishes so one should not bereave for the dead. *Panchtantra:* - the stories meant for **children** teach positive **human** values. Its message to the world is "Vaszadhaiva *Kutumbakam*" meaning the entire world is one family. Encyclopedic Spiritual Wisdom is available in our ancient literatures like the Upanishads; **Ramayana**; Mahabharata; Buddhist – Jain – Sufi & Sikh books of knowledge. The importance of the soul as doer (programmer) is emphasized in the Indian philosophy. Soul drives the body to act, and **commands** intellect.

4.6.2 Human Needs & Self-fulfillment

In modern education, the nearest to Indian approach is Abraham **Maslow.** He has tried to explain how Self-development takes place, through hierarchy of Needs. He placed 'physical needs' at the lowest level, then 'safety needs', 'social needs' and 'esteem needs' that rise upwards with 'self-actualization needs' at the top position. It is here that the sense of **fulfillment** becomes the maximum. (See Fig 4.6.2)



MASLOW'S HIERARCHY OF NEEDS

Fig, 4.6.2 (Lower to higher level of needs)

Source: http//www.softducks.com/maslow.Hierarchy

According to the psychologist Simons (1987) Abraham Maslow theory of personality called the hierarchic theory of needs has set up a hierarchy of five levels of basic needs. Beyond these needs, higher levels of needs exist. These include needs for understanding, esthetic appreciation and purely spiritual needs. In the levels of the five basic needs, the person does not feel the second need until the demands of the first have been satisfied, nor the third until the second has been satisfied, and so on. Maslow's basic needs are as follows:

- **Physiological Needs**

These are biological needs. They consist of needs for oxygen, food, water, and a relatively constant body temperature. They are the strongest needs because if a person were deprived of all needs, the physiological ones would come first in the person's search for satisfaction.

- **Safety Needs**

When all physiological needs are satisfied and are no longer controlling thoughts and behaviors, the needs for security can become active. Adults have little awareness of their security needs except in times of emergency or periods of disorganization in the social structure (such as widespread rioting). Children often display the signs of insecurity and the need to be safe.

- **Needs of Love, Affection and Belongingness**

When the needs for safety and for physiological well-being are satisfied, the next class of needs for love, affection and belongingness can emerge. Maslow states that people seek to overcome feelings of loneliness and alienation. This involves both giving and receiving love, affection and the sense of belonging.

- **Needs for Esteem**

When the first three classes of needs are satisfied, the needs for esteem can become dominant. These involve needs for both self-esteem and for the esteem a person gets from others. Humans have a need for a stable, firmly based, high level of self-respect, and respect fiom others. When these needs are satisfied, the person feels self-confident and valuable as a person in the world. When these needs are frustrated, the person feels inferior, weak, helpless and worthless.

- **Needs for Self-Actualization**

When all of the foregoing needs are satisfied, then and only then are the needs for self-actualization activated. Maslow describes self-actualization as a person's need to be and do that which the person was "born to do."

4.7 YOGA AND RELIGION

Yoga is not specific to any religion. Knowledge or practice of yoga deepens understanding of one's personal faith. It is concerned mainly with the ultimate reality. Through Yoga, we can evolve beyond our current ego-centric state. Yoga gives us fieedom to apply practices, suiting one's personal experience. Persons belonging to any faith can use yogic exercises for physical fitness, balancing nervous system and controlling the mind. Yoga transforms soul into super-soul.

4.7.1 Concept of Yoga

Yogic values refer to the holistic and spiritual approach towards life and the world. It is seriously being felt that the aim of education should also include the liberation of mind and soul as well. The system of Yoga may offer this kind of training and teaching.

Presently it is being seriously sensed that as the classical Indian tradition established four Noble Aims (Purusarth) in human life i.e. Ethics (Dharma), Earning (Artha), Enjoyment (Kama) and Emancipation (Moksha), which are equally essential and significant for sublime human existence in present time too, the education system should also impart the teaching and training of the moral (Dharma), socioeconomic (Artha), psychological (Kama) and spiritual (Moksha) values to the students. In different words Acharya Vinoba Bhave (1997), the spiritual heir of Mahatma Gandhi suggested the same, that 'education in India is to be based on three principles: Yoga (spiritual training;),Udyoga (vocational training;)and Sahayoga (social training;).

The word 'Yoga' means union with the Supreme power or God and it is 'Him' with whom we merge with at the end of our lives. Thousands of years ago, the Vedic people had started physical practice for controlling the mind, body and soul. This physical practice is known as yoga. Yoga is the ancient art, science and philosophy of maintaining a balance between these three most important elements of a human being by synchronizing them in a single chord. Yoga has various forms such as Raja Yoga, Karma yoga, Bhakti yoga, Kriya yoga or Kundalini yoga which aim to connect the 'Atma' with the 'Paramatma' or the human soul with the Supreme soul. It helps to merge the individual identity with the universal identity by creating a union. The definition of yoga is given in Patanjali's Yoga Sutra (1, 2), which is supposed to be the most important text of yoga philosophy. Patanjali systemized the scattered knowledge into holistic yoga practices. He divided Yoga System into eight-fold (physical to meditative) practices. It is known as "Ashtaang Yoga". Patanjali defines yoga as a state in which there is complete elimination of the thoughts and modifications of the mind. Patanjali states further that there are eight parts of this yoga, which when mastered individually and collectively, ultimately make that state come into being.

4.7.2 Benefits of Yoga

Myriad physical and mental benefits of yoga are a boon to the mankind

The ancient form of Yoga system was not aimed at management of disorders; nevertheless the aspects of health were covered in the foundation texts of Yoga (Shvetashwatara Upanisada/2/12; Bhagavatgita/6/17, 23; Yoga-Sutra/1/31, 32&2/2). It seems that in the Eight-limbic system of Yoga, ***Patanjali*** recommended the observance of ***Yama*** and ***Niyama,*** for the management of conscious emotional conflicts, whereas, and for the management of subconscious emotional conflicts he recommended Asana and Pranayama.

Yoga is an effective instrument of modification of human behavior. Yoga more closely resembles the methods of psychotherapy rather than a religion or a philosophy (Fritjof Capra, The Turning point, 1981). Selected routine of yogic exercises can certainly lead to a happy and successful healthy life.

Yoga renders self-education. The present education system conveys no training to develop an acquaintance with the abstract internal world of our Self. There is essentially a need to learn to understand the subtle realities concerned with the inert aspects of self-existence. Yoga imparts progressive training for the development of self-awareness and educate about the realities of our being and becoming.

The paramount aim of Yoga system is the pursuits of the transcendental state of psyche i.e. ***Samadhi*** which is a state of consciousness that begets energy, awareness and delight to the experiencing being for his/her creative thoughts and actions. ***Samadhi*** (transcendental state) further leads to wisdom.

Yoga involves silent communication with the environment, either with internal physiology or with external ecology, and this causes a new dimension for expansion of consciousness. Thus the path of Yoga is a test as well as the training of will power. Will power is a quality that plays its major role in every creative performance and success.

Stress can be controlled by recommended Yogic techniques (Udupa, 1978). The Yoga along-with recommended Yogic diet, reduces tension.

The practice of *Pratyahara* controlling the activities of senses, at both internal and external levels, manages the stresses of personal life and brings composure. The meditation on respiration, as in Vipasana of Bauddha system, was found to modify the state of mind. Yoga is a system of self-healing. Meditation stabilizing the functioning of autonomic nervous system causes remarkable reduction in anxiety and hypertension. The Yogic refinement in psychological attitude (Yama and Niyama of yoga) can reduce tension, improve health and resolve psychological conflicts. Both the internal and external environments can be balanced by such Yogic practice (Tripathi & Singh, 1984).

4.8 MEDITATION

Meditation or ***'Dhyana'*** was a part of ancient yoga practice. Meditation is the way of connecting to the God by developing a deeper level of consciousness. Through meditation an individual can communicate with the Almighty on the intra-personal level.

Meditation is journey of the mind or intellect from outer surface to the inner depths. In meditation we experience a refreshing and helping power of the universal spirit and we experience peace. All the time, mind acts in two ways:-

(i) As an open basket mind hops from one thought or activity to another. Five senses convey information in the mind-basket. Likes and dislikes of sense-organs are trained and controlled. Disciplining the mind can bring peace through meditation.

(ii) Mind collects information and converts it into knowledge. It transfers experiences from awareness to different levels of consciousness. Meditation tilts thoughts from conscious to subconscious and to the unconscious. Meditation helps one to attain intuitive or mystical levels of directly received knowledge. This mystical level is one of oneness with the Supreme Consciousness.

4.8.1 Five Features of Meditation

(1) Single Thought

(2) Effortlessness and relaxation

(3) Slowness

(4) Wakefulness and awareness of present moment

(5) Feeling the expanded lightness (to get enlightened)

Check Your Progress 2

1. What is Indian concept of *Ishvara*?

.....

.....

.....

2. What are the benefits of yoga?

.....

.....

.....

3. Name Maslow's hierarchy of Needs?

.....

.....

.....

.....

4. What are the features of Meditation?

.....

.....

.....

.....

4.9 SPIRITUAL INTEGRATION

Spiritual integration refers to a life that is full, open, loving and generous. It is not about attachment to dogmas, but about openness that redefines our experience of what it means to be alive and to be a human being. It allows for an evolving sense of union with life and with each other that is an antidote to the rigidities, *greed,* hatreds, and prejudices that destroy our world. Spiritual integration combines a deliberate cultivation of positive and life-nourishing impulses of thought and

behavior that transcends our habits and actions with a higher understanding and love. Thus silence and meditation help the human spirit to integrate with the Universal Spirit and create Harmony within. The integrated human personality harmonizes the inner and outer self.

4.10 LET US SUM UP

Spiritual Development is the highest conscious part of self-development. A well-balanced personality is a combination of body, mind and spirit. Such a person must have vision (of ambition) and mission (of purpose) in life. It is a progressive process of mergers and unity. Senses merge into mind Emotions of mind merge into intellect. Intellect merges into human consciousness of the soul. Soul (Spirit) merges into the Supreme Consciousness. *Our* feelings, thoughts and personality are rooted in our spiritual energy. Spirituality discovers inner self whereas Science discovers outer self. *Our* mind absorbs information from senses and transforms it into knowledge. Mindsets lead us to perform or prevent action. Happiness is created by our positive or negative thoughts. Ancient Indian thought stresses harmony between inner and outer self Meditation is a part of Yoga and provides a loving union between human and universal consciousness. Silent meditation purifies our mind, thoughts and feelings. A spiritual person loves all and develops peace within and around.

4.11 ANSWERS TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS

Answers to Check Your Progress 1

1. It is the cause and effect relationship. They must go hand in hand for the holistic development of human personality.
2. Spirituality is that aspect which relates to or affects the human spirit or soul as opposed to material or physical things.
3. Spiritual development gives substance to our religious life .Without spirituality; religion simply becomes a set of doctrines and practices that can never enrich life.
4. Happiness is the art of enjoying life's situations. Thoughts and mental conditioning create happiness.

Answers to Check Your Progress 2

1. The concept of ***Ishvara*** is the very core of Indian Philosophy. ***Ishvara*** in Sanskrit means, the Lord. In Indian philosophy therefore ***Ishvara*** is considered as the ultimate Ruler, the supreme power and is indeed the preternatural being of the ***Cosmos.***
2. Yoga cures number of ailing diseases, regular practice of yoga promises a stress free life and it also upholds the spiritual sense within human beings.
3. Maslow's hierarchy of needs is Physiological Needs, Security Needs, Social Needs Esteem Needs and Self-Actualization Needs.
4. The five features of Meditation are:

   Single Thought

Effortlessness & Relaxation

Slowness

Wakefulness and awareness of the present moment

Feeling the expanded lightness (to get enlightened)

4.12 REFERENCES

Dowling, Elizabeth ***M.*** & Scarlett W. George (2006). ***Encyclopedia of religious and Spirtiual Development,*** Sage Publications.

Foster, Richard J (1998.). ***Celebration of Discipline: The Path to Spiritual Growth,*** Harper, Sanfrancisco.

Fritjof Capra, (1981). 'The Turning Point' Flamingo, An Imprint of Harper Collins Publisher, London.

Leathers Helen & Campkin Diane (2009). ***The Spiritual & Psychic Development Workbook-A Beginner's Guide,*** STM, Publications, ***U.K.***

Safaya R.N, Shukla Dr.C.S. Bhatia B.D (1972). ***Modern Educational Psychology*** Dhanpat Rai Publishing Company (p) Ltd.Delhi.

Simons Janet A & Irwin Donald B. and Beverly A. Drinnien (1987). ***The Search for Understanding, West*** Publishing Company, New York

Tripathi ***K.M.*** & Singh R.H. (2003). 'Role of Yoga in the Management of Anxiety and Depression', ''The Yoga Review'', Vol. IX, No.1 & 2, p. 23-38.

(MAEDS PGDEDS PGCEDS)

ignou
THE PEOPLE'S
UNIVERSITY

Enrolment No.

Mobile No.

Name :

Programme of Study :

Year of Enrollment :

Year of Completion :

Age Group ι Below 30(01) •31-40(02) ι 41-50(03) ι 51 and Above (04)

Gender ι Male (01) ι Female (02)

Regional Centre/ Code . .

Study Centre/ Code

Course Material Evaluation for Students,

Dear Student, please take a few moments to answer the following questions regarding your experience with IGNOU's programme materials and process. This will help us in our continuous efforts to develop quality courses and processes.

Thank you.

Serial No	Questions	Very Satisfied	Satisfied	Undecided	Dissatisfied	Very Dissatisfied
1.	Was there sufficient information about the programme through its website and print media?					
2.	Did you receive your Student I-Card and enrolment number on time?					
3.	Did you receive The learning materials on time?					
4.	Did the contents in the print materials provide sufficient knowledge of the subject?					
5.	Was the quality and coverage of printed learning materials sufficient?					
6.	Did the supplementary study materials (audio/video) support you?					
7.	Were the counselling sections interactive?					
8.	Were the academic counselling sessions well organized?					
9.	Were the assignments provided and returned in time?					
10.	Were the project proposals clearly marked and discussed?					
11.	Were Hall Tickets for the Term-End Examination received on time?					
12.	Were result and grade cards of the examinations provided in time?					
13.	Please provide an overall rating for the programme that you attended.					